What each platform measures

Platform	Measurement unit	Analysis route	Output / qualification
Sanger	Cloned amplicon	Q ≥ 20 changes counted; background reported alongside	Per-clone load and spectrum; shared readable window
Nanopore	Amplicon read	Control-calibrated variants; optional UMI consensus	Long positional span; junction-defined clones
Illumina	Merged paired read	Control-calibrated variants; reference and layout stated	Mutation burden and signature; span limited by read layout
PacBio	Switch-junction read	Junction alignment and unique-junction summaries	Microhomology, insertions; placement ambiguity checked

Measurement units and counting rules differ across routes; absolute densities should not be treated as interchangeable.